Q&A Tracker - October 1, 2026

7/6/26	Consent Agenda	Resource Synergy Contract is $136,393.20 for waste sensors. Have we ever done a look-back to see if this saves money? The company website indicates that it can save a district 10-15%, which made me wonder, how much has it saved the district since the sensors were placed?	Resource Synergy has identified approximately $116,500 in overbilling (savings from Q1 2022 through Q1 2024) that the District has actively worked with our waste haulers to refund to PPS in credits. Additionally, the benefit is that PPS, as an organization, is reducing our carbon footprint by only having our haulers address pick-ups when they are necessary rather than emptying empty containers. We continue to work with Resource Synergy on savings and right-sizing our waste containers for efficiency.
7/6/26	Consent Agenda	Multco PFA: This is a great program and revenue stream for the District. It's a fantastic way to introduce neighborhood families to their schools before kindergarten. Have there been any conversations about expanding this to all PPS elementary schools?	We agree that Preschool for All is a great revenue stream and partnership. Since PFA's inception, PPS has integrated an increasing number of PFA seats into our braided early learners' program each year. In this coming school year 2026-27, 273 of our 901 PPS PreK seats will be funded by PFA. We also welcome priority partners who are funded by PFA into our space to increase capacity (e.g. CAIRO, MECP, Albina Early Head Start, etc). While the goal of adding PFA classrooms to every PPS elementary school is unlikely - as that would not necessarily align with the vision of a mixed delivery model of PFA - we will continue to strategically expand our partnership with PFA as district funding, capacity, enrollment, and community needs allow.

8/17/26	Rightsizing	At a recent board meeting, I asked about where answers to the community questions gathered at the 6+ community involvement meetings. I was told answers are in the FAQ section of the rightsizing website. However, at the time (and still now), there are only 6 questions answered, and one of them is a question about teacher furlough days. I know we gathered dozens (at least) of community questions and would like to know when they will all be up and when they will be answered?	We gathered a substantial volume of feedback across the six community meetings, and our team is systematically consolidating and categorizing those questions to ensure every concern is thoroughly addressed. We have recently published an updated batch of answers to the Rightsizing FAQ page, addressing several new topics. Moving forward, we strive to publish weekly updates to the site through this process.
8/13/26	n/a	Where will middle schoolers will run track and field in the spring. I don't have the track / field renovation calendar handy, but when will those renovations start? Is there a way to have them start after track and field ends in the spring, so middle schoolers can still practice there? It is a huge squad as I understand it.	Regarding use of Cleveland Field. The Cleveland field has been off-line since the week of July 27th, with construction starting on the Track and Field Schedule Q2/Q3 2027. Cleveland Youth Track will practice at the Marshall campus. This information was also shared at the FIO meeting in May. Please let me know if you have other questions. https://meetings.boardbook.org/Public/Agenda/915?meeting=747392
8/11/26	n/a	I'm wondering if you have all made the decision to open boys volleyball up to PIL schools (officially)	We cannot offer any new OSAA sports this year in light of the budget. As a reminder we organized a club league for our schools and other districts and we will continue to utilize this option in the time being until our budget is stabilized enough for us to bring on new OSAA sanctioned sports.
8/3/26	Consent Agenda	PS98109, how is this different than the contract we approved in June for temporary staffing for IT services, and why do we need another $600,000?	This was answered in the board meeting

8/5/26	Rightsizing	Could you please ask Dr. Greene (or Margaret or Jon) for the data referenced by Dr. Greene last night when I asked about families leaving PPS during / post-SEGC	The information referenced can be found on pages 48-50 in Domain 2. This secttion reviews the dual language immersion programs specifically. The information looks not only at enrollment in the program after it was relocated but also at enrollment in the district as well. p. 49 shows the summmary graph of the percentage of students leaving the district comparing students enrolled in DLI programs and those not enrolled in DLI. "Taken together, these findings suggest that SEGC-related DLI program relocations did not appear to result in widespread district exit among DLI students." (p.49).
8/3/26	Consent Agenda	Re: DR 98148, why are we doing social emotional learning online? (the irony of this is not lost on me) Could you please explain whether this is a new contract or a renewed contract? And if new, why are we doing this online?	The social emotional curricular tool, We Do it for the Culture, is not an online program. We purchased digital licenses for this program, but it is for teacher resources only. This program integrates multimedia into their curriculum, but students are not working independently (or in groups) on their computers. All of the SEL curricula are hands-on and interactive; none of the three programs are virtual programs.
	Rightsizing	Could you please provide data on the number of kids vs. enrollment? Are the number of kids truly declining or just enrollment at PPS because parents are making other choices because of unsafe/large classrooms?	Our research does not support the premise that parents are not choosing PPS due to "large/unsafe" classrooms. Here are the results of our study about why families leave: PPS-Why They Stay and Leave - Summary Re… Regarding enrollment, PPS enrollment has been declining since the 18-19 school year. Several factors are impacting our enrollment: Catchment percentages are lower, birth rates continue to decline, and fewer families are moving into Portland since the pandemic and those families are not having children or bringing school-aged children to Portland. Neighborhood catchment rates are published on our website: https://www.pps.net/fs/resource-manager/view/d65fc6

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	Rightsizing	As we begin our right-sizing conversation, could you please provide me with the testing data (math, ELA, etc.) for the schools that are under 300, over the last few years (maybe since the year before COVID since that is when this downward enrollment trend gained speed).	We have created a public dashboard and within it, developed an OSAS/Enrollment tab to see the relationship between school size and enrollment. At this time, no relationship is noted. Here is the link to the dashboard: https://www.pps.net/departments/dataaccountability/data-and-accountability/data-strategy-and-insights/academic-portal

	Rightsizing	(1) where are people going? I am looking specifically for data on where people went after we closed or consolidated schools. Specific examples could be: ** when we closed Marshall, how many families left PPS but remained within PPS boundaries? ** same for Edwards - when that was closed 20 years ago, how many families left instead of going to Sunnyside/Abernethy/Buckman? **And most recently, when Bridger was consolidated, I'd love to see numbers of class sizes over the last couple of years.Specifically, after merger, how many 1st grade families who became the next year's 2nd grade families left and where did they go? I'd love that info for each grade level as they progressed to the next year. I've asked for this before, so apologies if this has been answered. If it has been answered, please point me to where it is. (2) are we rightsizing the large elementary schools, too? I ask because in 2019-20, before the pandemic, Abernethy was overcrowded (over 550 students) and the kindergarten classrooms each had 29-30 kids in them. It was a beast of a school so more was not necessarily better. (I specifically heard this question asked at the Wells engagement session so it got me thinking) (3) how many empty buildings does PPS own and how much does it cost, per year, to maintain them. (4) what will happen to the closed schools? (5) ***** how much will we save, per school closed, to close a school? ***** we need to have a number for this, even if it's not a lot.	This was shared last March.

		(6) For right sizing, will there be a commitment to do more than the bare minimum staffing? We can't close schools only to offer people what they have in their small school now. We need to offer MORE to incentivize! (6a) what will we offer? (7) for neighborhood schools, which are losing kids to lottery schools, will we make a commitment to offer more to them? So for families who choose a focus option / lotter / DLI program, they get the *extra* that's offered at that focus option school. But how about we offer extremely small classrooms and something like a language special starting in kindergarten at all the neighborhood schools. We have got to focus on the beautiful neighborhood schools and elevate them! (8) ***** like we did for Jefferson ***** can we draw boundaries of maybe 1 mile around elementary schools? I suspect there are a lot of families who live further from the school they attend than another schools. My family as an example: we live 1.1 miles from Abernethy, which means we get a yellow bus route option (costs money). But we live .6 from Sunnyside and .6 fro Richmond. If either of those were our neighborhood school, PPS would save money because there wouldn't be a yellow bus cost associated. I am certain this happens at a lot of other schools, so can we please take a look at what happens if we draw boundaries of 1 mile around elementary schools? (9) for the neighborhood school model, which we hear mostly bad things about, will we be reconsidering those models and making sure to properly staff them so the program succeeds? And will we commit to no further such	

		schools until the ones in the model are thriving?	
	Rightsizing	(1) what is the estimated cost savings to closing a school? (2) how many lay offs are anticipated with each school closing? I realize there is nuance to this as not all positions at a closed school will be eliminated, and some positions may move to a new location. So I guess I am asking for the general estimated loss, taking the nuance into consideration.	The number of potential layoffs can not be determined at this time. What we do know is that school consolidations will results in fewer school based staff members, from the custodians to the building leaders. The most impacted positions are those where there is one per building, such as a principal, custodian, possibly a school counselor, etc.
	n/a	I was chatting with a new Ockley Green mom yesterday and she was expressing alarm at getting an invitation to join a "new" school app called Live School Support. The email she received had her son's name and that he was at Ockley Green. She went through the sign up process, thinking this was something all middle schools use. They're a 6th grade family. Once in the app, the platform's face sheet had "merit" and "demerit" points that her child was receiving at school. And it has a behavioral profile. She is absolutely shocked and alarmed and I told her I'd let the district know asap. Keeping track of merit and demerit points of kids seems suspicious to say the least, and once it's on an application, it is there forever. I am hoping you can look into this and advise on its legitimacy.	Thank you for bringing this to our attention. The LiveSchool platform was requested by two middle schools and is presently going through our formal vetting and approval process. This standard evaluation includes a thorough review of student data privacy and software security requirements before any approval decision is made.

9/1/26	Transportation issue	I have received an email from a West Sylvan parent about the persistent delays in getting to school because of train hold-ups. She says that the West Sylvan community has been trying to resolve the problem for years but that PPS has done nothing. I know that you worked wonders with the Access bus situation, and I hope that you can do something similar with this problem. Please let me know if you can meet with me and/or the parent who is trying to find a solution. You may have heard about this already from Rosanne, so you may be working on it already. Please keep me posted.	We have connected the parent with Brandon Coonrod, Director of Transportation.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	what does it look like if we were to have supply (of focus option schools) meet demand (so no waitlists)	Broadly, if you wanted everybody who asked for a focus option and did not get an offer you would add kindergarten sections at Winterhaven and Sunnyside, 6th grade sections at da Vinci and 9th grade sections at Benson. We are meeting demand for all dual language immersion languages except Spanish. If additional sections were added at Ainsworth, Beach and/or Atkinson, the programs would no longer conform to the two-way immersion model because the waitlists consist of English and Heritage speakers only, not native speakers. There are just under 600 students who are currently on a waitlist for a focus option or dual language immersion programs.

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9/4/26	n/a	Can we please fix this restroom issue (PTA Clothing Closet) ? My understanding is that there's a bathroom that locks with a key right across from the clothing closet, and that using it does not put visitors in the path of kids. We have to support the dignity of the folks using the clothing center. They're PPS families and would be able to use the restroom if they were visiting for another purpose.	The Clothes Closet did have more space in previous years when it served as a swing space most recently for Benson. This is because Benson, for the programming that it offered, did not necessitate needing the space. With Cleveland moving over this changed. They will need that space for programming. -The Clothes Closet did move to a different space within Marshall, it is smaller, and we remodeled the space and provided storage. The space does have access to an outer door which allows students and families more privacy and discretion. -Section 4.21 of the lease states: In its use of the Premises, Licensee and its volunteers shall have right to use the Building restroom #A19 immediately across the hall from the Premises. The public shall not have access to restrooms at the Building. Licensee shall be allowed, but not required, to install a Porta Potty at the exterior northwest corner of Space A21 under the terms and conditions as outlined in Exhibit B. -The Staff and volunteers of the Clothing Center will have access to a permanent restroom within the school building. The patrons (public) do not have use of the permanent restroom. -Moving forward, we will continue looking at alternative spaces for a more sustainable venue to house the Clothes Closet, and given the rightsizing conversation this will also serve as an opportunity for a more permanent space. It is confirmed with the principal that the bathroom is accessible to students. The ISC classroom is the closest classroom and that is the bathroom that they

			use.
9/3/26	n/a	Has a porta-potty been installed (PTA Clothing Closet)? I keep thinking about the single parent with 2-3 young kids whose kids need the bathroom and the parent is in deep trouble. (I had three under 18 months and potty trained all 3 at once so this fear resonates closely with me)	The principal has confirmed that everything is going fine. As of today the Clothes Closet has not installed a portable bathroom but they absolutely can if they feel it is a need.
9/14/26	n/a	can staff please provide tardy data for Cleveland High School students the first 12 days of school this year vs. the first 12 days of school last year? I would like to assess the impact of Cleveland's transportation plan on attendance.	Gathering last years tardy for specific points in time is actually not an easy thing to do. Their attendance overall seems higher than last year at this time, and finding the tardy data is not something we can easily gather at this time.
9/14/26	CMGC-Grice-Adair	The Grice-Adair draft findings CMGC memo states "Project budget is expected to be in the range of $60M with Summer 2027 targeted as the approximate start date for project related construction." The total budget for Grice-Adair is $60M inclusive of the building purchase of $16M, leaving $44M for the project budget. Can staff please revise/clarify the memo for Boardbook?	Our intent was to reference the TOTAL amount of the project, not just the construction budget. Total project budget is $60M, minus purchase of property for $16M, leaving $44M for renovations. We estimate the total construction cost to be in the Range of $35-40M.

9/15/26	n/a	The Board has received recently from JDLI instructors about the class sizes for Japanese at Grant. Are the numbers below accurate and, if so, is there a plan to add an instructor?	There are two sections of large class sizes. This is the message from the teacher and VP: We are excited to welcome Koichiro Uno to Grant's JDLI program! Koichiro will be volunteering with our 11th- and 12th-grade Japanese classes during Periods 5 and 6, working alongside our students and supporting their continued growth in Japanese language and culture. Koichiro brings extensive experience in Japanese language education and a strong connection to our immersion community. He holds an M.A. in Japanese and an M.Ed. through the International Teacher Education Program at Portland State University. He is currently a Visiting Assistant Professor of Japanese at Willamette University and has also supported students preparing for the AP Japanese Language and Culture Exam through Oya no Kai. Many in our community may already know Koichiro through his work with PPS and Grant. He previously served as a Japanese Language Assistant at Richmond Elementary, has volunteered in Richmond classrooms, and has served as an on-site coordinator for Grant High School's Japan Cultural Trip for the past three summers. We are incredibly fortunate to have someone with Koichiro's experience, knowledge, and longstanding connection to our community volunteering his time with our students. His presence will provide our 11th- and 12th-grade students with another opportunity to strengthen their language skills, deepen their cultural learning, and engage with an experienced Japanese educator. Please join us in giving Koichiro a warm welcome to Grant! We are so glad to have him as part

			of our JDLI program.
9/15/26	n/a	As we are adding the iReady interim assessments, it seems like we are hanging on to others so that at least in middle school math, kids are doing iReady, Synergy, and eventually OSAS. How can we at least keep online testing time where it has been, and not add to it, with the new state requirement? I feel like I understood the plan to be that we'd drop the interim testing we were doing and replace it, rather than double up.	Please see response
9/15/26	n/a	I'm constantly hearing that we've increased central office administrators by 79 since 2019. Is this true? If not, what is true or where can I try to track this down?	FY25 Financial Report (pages 142-143) shows staffing FTE by type. This does not include supports that may be provided by a contractor. FTE Type FY25 FY19 Teachers 2,665.7 2,697.3 Ed Assistants 677.4 647.1 School Admin 167.2 165.5 District Admin 4.0 16.0 Other FTE 2,607.5 2,048.1 Total FTE 6,121.8 5,574.0 NOTE: This is FTE for all funds. Student Investment Account and High School Success are funding sources that became available after 2019 and fund many FTE.

9/15/26	n/a	I heard from a teacher in Zone 1 sharing concerns about e-bikes and e-scooters. Unrelated, our school newsletter this week included a solid message on this and I wondered if the district might consider a policy in the longer term and a district-wide message in the interim?	HB 4007 - There are a couple of places that talk about ebikes and scooters. Here's PBOT: https://www.portland.gov/transportation/regulatory/escooterpdx?utm_medium=email&utm_source=govdelivery and then some school districts have sent out good stuff too. Here is an example: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1cqPugsawhX5Gd_FQPQKWiAF31M_zDhEccDk-j58kG1g/edit?tab=t.0 Based upon the June legislation. If you scroll down in the link above there's a graphic with ages and what's allowed and not allowed.
9/15/26	Bond Update	I'm reviewing the Board meeting materials for Tuesday. Could staff please provide the underlying data and documentation supporting the savings reflected on the slide below, including the methodology used to calculate the $20.8M in "realized savings" and the 225% ROI? I think it's particularly important that we clearly distinguish actual savings from reallocations, negotiated costs, and process efficiencies. If the supporting documentation isn't available, I would recommend removing this slide.	PPS Value Add Register

9/15/26	Rightsizing	Do we have an easy-to-read year-over-year capture rate data sheet broken down by school?	We only have In District Capture rate by school which is different from the capture rate in general for the district. This looks at the percentage of PPS students living in a neighborhood boundary that attend their neighborhood school. It does not include students who live in a PPS boundary but attend a non-PPS Charter, private school or are home schooled. This is the most recent for overall from the PRC report - In fall 2025, Portland Public Schools (PPS) enrolled 42,622 students in grades K–12, a decrease of 753 students from fall 2024 and sitting just over 6,000 students below the pre-pandemic baseline of 201920. Post-pandemic trajectories have diverged among individual schools within the PPS system; some have returned to pre-pandemic enrollment patterns, while others continue to experience persistently low enrollment in their neighborhoods. The overall resident capture rate in the district has increased from 74.4% in fall 2019 to an estimated 76.6% in 2025. However, this recent recovery is still 5.6 percentage points lower than the district's previous high of 82.2% in 2015. PRC Report

9/17/26	Rightsizing	This is similar to the question that I was asking (the associated costs of needed improvements for each building as well). Is there a current existing building condition report? I feel like there is… if there is not, we are going to run into issues with families (and board members 🙋) calling out that we haven't taken that data into consideration when we are assessing which buildings to close. Thanks for looking into this.	Yes — we are taking a significant amount of facility data into consideration as part of the Rightsizing analysis, including building condition and reliability, environmental health, life safety, accessibility, educational suitability, safe access to school, functional capacity, and utilization; however, we do not have a single current building-condition report that represents the full analysis that is available for public review. We are intentionally looking at these factors together rather than using a single facility score or data point to determine whether a school should close. The Operations team is also evaluating receiving-school readiness and will complete additional in-person building assessments to identify what investments may be needed. That work will inform the implementation plan and recommendations to the Board about the sequencing and timing of facility investments, as required through Resolution 7307.)
9/14	n/a	Was the RFP issue or has the previous construction auditor been engaged?	We are researching prior RFPs and current contracted services for the District to make sure we are not double paying for services. We are meeting this week to determine next steps and map out a timeline which we will communicate with you. For your information, a construction auditor audits the projects within the program (i.e. Monitoring cost controls with the CMGCs). Given we are not to GMP yet on any of our major modernizations we have some time to determine our best course of action.
9/21/26	n/a	Can staff please provide all existing contracts and amendments for a vendor called Paloma Learning?	Staff sent the contracts to Director La Forte

9/21/26	n/a	Is there an updated reconciliation that you can share? It looks like we still have a $6M hole. Is that case? I don't think we can carry over a deficit, can we? What happens if we can't close it? Happy to discuss this if it's easier.	We are still in the year-end reconciliation process. I hope to have an (unaudited) June financial report posted by the end of this month. We asked the board to approve appropriation changes that would allow us to lower the fund balance in June, if necessary. If the final reconciliation is below the 5% target, we will have to adjust the current year resources (beginning fund balance) to match. It will be very close as we watch estimated savings become actuals for the year.
9/23/26	n/a	I'm so glad that we've been able to resolve the bathroom issue at the PTA Clothing Closet. I want to make sure that the lease is updated to reflect the changes are documented. Who owns that body of work, and is there a timeline for updating the lease? I've had some questions about this from the community.	Staff will update the lease but it will take a few weeks, and will let you know when it is completed.

9/28/26	n/a	We're getting a couple of waves of emails about the upcoming construction at Wells. The concerns are: Fencing off Wells property during construction Public access to Wells' outdoor facilities once construction is complete Regarding the first, is there a way to preserve public access to at least part of the property during construction? Is completely fencing off the property truly necessary? If it is, fine—but we need to communicate why that is. Regarding the second, public access to the outdoor facilities after construction is a serious issue. School property is public property, and other high schools allow community access outside of school hours when the outdoor facilities are not being formally used by students. Our schools are community assets and we should be facilitating as much access as possible. Can we reconsider this now and communicate that—post-construction—we will allow the same access to Wells' outdoor facilities that we allow at other schools?	First and foremost, student safety is at the forefront of every decision made regarding campus access. The Ida B. Wells campus will allow generous public access, similar to, if not greater than the type of access that occurs at Lincoln, Cleveland and Jefferson. The Wells campus also includes an elementary school, Rieke, that brings special considerations for public use. The Wells campus is largely owned by PPS and not the Parks Bureau. It is different therefore from a campus like Grant which shares ownership and use with the Portland Parks Bureau. There are no current rights of public access to the Ida B Wells or Rieke campus, but for access to the Parks Bureau operated public pool. The conditional use permit that was approved by the city staff and affirmed by the city's Hearings Officer grants extensive public access to the campus in the following ways: There will be four new public access easements that allow pedestrian, vehicle and bike access through the campus. Three of these easements provide this access during and after school hours; Access to the public pool, owned and operated by the Parks Bureau, will be maintained and parking and circulation to the pool for the public will be enhanced and improved; The school will continue to be the public location for the Farmer's Market, again with enhanced circulation and parking;

			The proposal includes new field lighting which will extend the utility of the fields at PPS expense. These fields will be open to the public through the civic use of buildings program that applies to all schools equally across the district, east side and west side; and PPS has acknowledged that informal use of the school grounds will continue in non-school hours as long as that use does not lead to vandalism or other safety or cost concerns. PPS put data in the record showing the vandalism and theft that has occurred at IBW and how access without limitations is costly and impedes PPS ability to secure its assets.

9/29/26	n/a	Can you give me a “tell me like I’m five” overview of situation regarding public access to Wells’ outdoor facilities after construction is completed? The community is telling us that PPS will not allow access—that the facilities will be locked when not in use by students during non-school hours. This is not typical of other high school campuses and has been a significant source of contention when it has come up in the past. What specifically has been communicated to the Wells community in terms of access?	First and foremost, student safety is at the forefront of every decision made regarding campus access. The Ida B. Wells campus will allow generous public access, similar to, if not greater than the type of access that occurs at Lincoln, Cleveland and Jefferson. The Wells campus also includes an elementary school, Rieke, that brings special considerations for public use. The Wells campus is largely owned by PPS and not the Parks Bureau. It is different therefore from a campus like Grant which shares ownership and use with the Portland Parks Bureau. There are no current rights of public access to the Ida B Wells or Rieke campus, but for access to the Parks Bureau operated public pool. The conditional use permit that was approved by the city staff and affirmed by the city’s Hearings Officer grants extensive public access to the campus in the following ways: There will be four new public access easements that allow pedestrian, vehicle and bike access through the campus. Three of these easements provide this access during and after school hours; Access to the public pool, owned and operated by the Parks Bureau, will be maintained and parking and circulation to the pool for the public will be enhanced and improved; The school will continue to be the public location for the Farmer’s Market, again with enhanced circulation and parking;

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9/1/26	Rightsizing	what does it look like if we were to have supply (of focus option schools) meet demand (so no waitlists)	This is best answered by providing you current waitlist information for Focus Option and Dual Language Immersion programs. Currently, about 600 students remain on those waitlists today. Here is a list by school, type and grade. Only top choices are shown so students are not duplicated and they are limited DLI to Kinder waitlists since entry to upper grades is primarily determined by language assessments.

9/1/26	Rightsizing	where are people going? I am looking specifically for data on where people went after we closed or consolidated schools. Specific examples could be: ** when we closed Marshall, how many families left PPS but remained within PPS boundaries? ** same for Edwards - when that was closed 20 years ago, how many families left instead of going to Sunnyside/Abernethy/Buckman? **And most recently, when Bridger was consolidated, I'd love to see numbers of class sizes over the last couple of years.Specifically, after merger, how many 1st grade families who became the next year's 2nd grade families left and where did they go? I'd love that info for each grade level as they progressed to the next year. I've asked for this before, so apologies if this has been answered. If it has been answered, please point me to where it is.	It would take significant effort to answer this question about the student movement from the closure of Marshall fifteen years ago and Edwards twenty years ago. We are also looking at something like this districtwide. Overall metrics indicate that while building retention dropped during consolidation, district retention remained stable at over 93%, showing that the majority of departing families transferred to other schools within PPS rather than exiting the district.

9/1/26	Rightsizing	are we rightsizing the large elementary schools, too? I ask because in 2019-20, before the pandemic, Abernethy was overcrowded (over 550 students) and the kindergarten classrooms each had 29-30 kids in them and kids were in overflow buildings that were condemned three years ago and finally torn down last year. It was a beast of a school so more was not necessarily better. (I specifically heard this question asked at the Wells engagement session so it got me thinking)	We are defining sustainable schools as an elementary school with stable enrollment of 360 or more. An elementary school with 500 or more students would fall into this category of stable school.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	how many empty buildings does PPS own and how much does it cost, per year, to maintain them. what will happen to the closed schools?	We only have two vacant buildings: Kenton and Smith. Kenton is being short term leased, and is being evaluated as a potential swing space for students while their building is undergoing seismic retrofits. Smith's annual cost was approximately $70,000, including insurance costs. Future use of any closed school is still to be determined. Closure does not automatically mean that a property will be sold or disposed of. As part of implementation planning, staff will develop a comprehensive building repurposing plan that includes community engagement and aligns with applicable board policy and administrative directives governing the future use or disposition of district property.

9/1/26	Rightsizing	For right sizing, will there be a commitment to do more than the bare minimum staffing? We can't close schools only to offer people what they have in their small school now. We need to offer MORE to incentivize! so ... (6a) what exactly will we offer?	There will be a commitment to shift as many schools as possible toward the programmatic components of the well-resourced schools framework, as described on the “hypothetical future state” slides at the TLE Committee (see below). That said, it is important to note that, given our looming budget deficit, if we do nothing, all schools will continue to experience the types of challenges described on the “current state” slides in the TLE Committee presentation--and, that current state will likely get worse (e.g. more blended classrooms, possibility of shared or split administrators, less likelihood of all students receiving all core enrichment programs, etc). It is important to understand that our current staffing model is the status quo. In order to offer more, the status quo would not be able to stay the same.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	for neighborhood schools, which are losing kids to lottery schools, will we make a commitment to offer more to them? So for families who choose a focus option / lotter / DLI program, they get the *extra* that's offered at that focus option school. But how about we offer extremely small classrooms and something like a language special starting in kindergarten at all the neighborhood schools. We have got to focus on the beautiful neighborhood schools and elevate them!	As directed by the Board, we are working to stabilize neighborhood schools, while also maintaining some choices for families. Rightsizing will allow us to ensure that our neighborhood and focus programs have the staffing and resources they need to offer a well-rounded and comprehensive academic and enrichment program. Because we are still facing an impending budget gap, we are not in a position to consider new programming (e.g. elementary language courses) at this time.

9/1/26	Rightsizing	**** like we did for Jefferson ***** can we draw boundaries of maybe 1 mile around elementary schools? I suspect there are a lot of families who live further from the school they attend than other schools. My family as an example: we live 1.1 miles from Abernethy, which means we get a yellow bus route option (costs money). But we live .6 from Sunnyside and .6 from Richmond. If either of those were our neighborhood school, PPS would save money because there wouldn't be a yellow bus cost associated. I am certain this happens at a lot of other schools, so can we please take a look at what happens if we draw boundaries of 1 mile around elementary schools? (there is a Creston family who lives directly across from Richmond)	Yes, We will share similar visuals showing the density of students from elementary, K8 and middle schools with circles indicating a one mile (elementary) and 1.5 mile (for middle schools) radius. The Cleveland/Franklin region in Portland has the highest number of schools. This means that they are close to each other and when we have focus option schools or programs next to neighborhood schools, the neighborhood attendance area may have the focus option school within it.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	or the neighborhood school model, which we hear mostly bad things about, will we be reconsidering those models and making sure to properly staff them so the program succeeds? And will we commit to no further such schools until the ones in the model are thriving?	The Special Education department is currently drafting a response to this.

9/1/26	Rightsizing	How does PPS define “functional capacity” versus “building capacity” when calculating utilization? What utilization percentage is considered “efficient” or appropriate, and what standards or research inform that threshold? Are any equity considerations or adjustments applied to this calculation, particularly for Title I schools or schools serving higher-need populations?	Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school site can accommodate. PPS calculates it as a model based on the capacity of each classroom which is determined by its size in square feet and the approximate percentage of a school day that the instructional spaces are used. The utilization rate identifies how much of the gross capacity is being used. Most schools do not use 100 percent of the available student capacity in the building every period of every day. Gross capacity is based on the capacity of each classroom (Classrooms less than 800 SF have a student capacity of 24; classrooms greater than 800 SF and less than 1,000 SF have a student capacity of 27; classrooms greater than 1,000 SF have a student capacity of 30.). PPS defines Efficient Utilization as a school operating between 70% and 100% of its Functional Capacity. Schools operating within this range generally align student enrollment with available physical footprint. This baseline generally supports the education program while maintaining room flexibility for dedicated health services, early childhood programs, and community partnerships. K-5 and K-8 schools have a base utilization rate set to 100%, then scheduling complexities are acknowledged with utilization rate reductions for: Title I TSI or CSI neighborhood K-8 (not a focus option) Co-located neighborhood and immersion programs In addition, classroom counts are reduced for non-homeroom classrooms. These include: Computer labs Gymnasiums

			One Special Ed Learning Center One or two Art/Music rooms, depending on enrollment formula Early Childhood Leased spaces
9/1/26	Rightsizing	As we begin our right-sizing conversation, could you please provide me with the testing data (math, ELA, etc.) for the schools that are under 300, post COVID?	This public dashboard shows there is no data supporting that smaller schools have higher test scores. Test scores are better predicted by socio-economic status than school size.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	FAQs? They appear to not have been updated since April and there are only 6 FAQs but really only 5 because one of them is about the furlough days. We likely got hundreds of questions from community members. When will they be pulled and posted and answered?	New FAQs are being added today and will be updated weekly.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	keep referencing 360 and 500, presume from Dr. Green's report and the QEM. But no mention of average class sizes. In Dr. Green's report, taken from the QEM, it suggests classroom sizes need to be factored in	We reviewed the methodology suggested by Dr. Green to determine enrollment thresholds for sustainable schools. He suggested we use three frames of reference: peer districts, prototype models (QEM), and local models. These thresholds do not speak to specific class size. "Rather, they should be understood as planning floors that help PPS assess whether schools are likely to remain large enough over time to sustain the staffing, programming, relationships, and student supports associated with well-resourced schools. " p. 141. Similarly the research on school size has tensions. "The research on school size does not support a simple conclusion that smaller schools are always better or that larger schools are always more efficient. Instead, the literature points to a set of tradeoffs (regarding school size) that PPS must hold together. The research suggests that smaller schools often provide stronger relationships, greater student visibility, easier family connection, and more intimate school climates. Larger schools often provide more staffing flexibility, more program breadth,

			stronger grade-level or subject-area teams, and greater capacity to offer specialists, electives, and intervention support.” p.141
9/1/26	Rightsizing	housing being built around schools (like Creston and Glencoe). Are we considering how those new buildings will affect enrollment in the very near future?	Yes, the Population Research Center at PSU takes into account new housing developments. They model the effects of income restricted housing.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	How will K-8 model come into play? Would PPS close a middle school before converting a K8 to a K5 and moving the 6-8 to a middle school?	School consolidation scenarios are dependent on many regional factors. Each region has separate needs and considerations such as space, geography, programs and number of schools. We are considering all levers for change including program moves, boundary changes, grade level reconfigurations and closures in this process.
9/1/26	Rightsizing	Could you please provide data on the number of kids vs. enrollment? Are the number of kids truly declining or just enrollment at PPS because parents are making other choices because of unsafe/large classrooms?	Here is the PPS Enrollment Forecast from 2026-27 to 2035-36 from Portland State's Population Research Center. This was updated on July 24, 2026 and provides the source enrollment data we are using to analyze enrollment and model.

9/2/26	Rightsizing	I have seen a lot of news recently (likely thanks to AI listening and algorithms) on "what happened 10 years after rightsizing" in districts like Philadelphia and Chicago. Both of those districts closed a large percentage of their schools and the studies now suggest an increase in gun violence around closed schools and that students in "receiving" schools had test scores go down. This is not to mention that families did indeed leave the district. I've included some articles and those articles include studies from Johns Hopkins, University of Chicago and University of Pennsylvania.. So I guess my questions are (1) How do we know we won't have the same outcome, one where no money is saved, student enrollment is lost and communities are shattered? And (2) are we looking nation-wide at how districts have fared post-closure? Chair Wang has casually mentioned "Chicago closes schools all the time" as a good thing, but research suggests that is not quite accurate. Public school closings in Chicago linked to more gun violence in nearby neighborhoods | University of Chicago News	(1) In the recent changes from the southeast enrollment balancing there was no evidence of differences in student outcomes (discipline, attendance or academics) between students that experienced changes and those who did not. In addition, while there has been an enrollment decline overall in the district, the decline in southeast was not significantly different from the district overall. (2) Yes, we're learning from rightsizing efforts happening in districts across the country, and that includes looking honestly at what went well and what didn't. Some of that research is cautionary, and we're not dismissing it. On student outcomes, what it tells us consistently is that students who attend well-resourced schools — strong academics, stable staffing, student supports, and access to programs — do better. Rightsizing is designed to increase PPS students' access to that, regardless of which building they're in. The June 2026 equity audit from our Southeast Enrollment Balancing effort found no significant negative changes in student outcomes, and modest positive gains for several student groups. That doesn't guarantee every future decision goes the same way, but we're committed to applying those lessons in this work. On site closures: the equity audit recommends that any PPS closure plan include a building disposition plan, a maintenance and security cost estimate, a community reuse process, and a realistic sale/lease/reuse/demolition timeline, decided before closure votes, not after. Future use of any closed school is still to be determined — closure does not automatically mean a property will be sold or disposed of. As part of implementation planning, staff will develop a comprehensive building repurposing plan that includes community engagement and aligns with applicable Board policy and administrative directives governing the future use or disposition of district property.

		Chicago Closed 50 Schools 10 Years Ago. What's Happened Since Then? (I don't know "Block Club Chicago" but quick internet research suggests it is a hyper-local neighborhood-focused newsroom in Chicago) 17 Philadelphia schools closing in 2027: What to know - WHYY with a link to a 2019 study out of the University of Pennsylvania: "A 2019 study from the University of Pennsylvania found that following these closures, displaced students received more suspensions and were absent more compared to their peers."	

9/4/26	Rightsizing	(1) I hear a lot of "we need to make sure all schools are getting art and music and library and PE". Could you please send me a list of schools that are not getting all 4 of these already? And in that list, could you include whether the art/music/PE/library teacher is part or full time? (2) a lot of schools - when 350+ students - are pretty full, almost bursting at the seems. When there are more classes in each grade and more students in the building, are we preparing for: (a) where will these specials live? and (b) will there be enough time in the day / week to schedule each class in each grade for each special? Has this been discussed? Lastly, (3) how are utilization rates being calculated? For example, at Creston, every single classroom in the building is being occupied and most of the classes are at (or above) capacity. But Creston is still showing a low utilization rate. As a follow-up to (3), Creston houses the CRIS program and P4A. Are we factoring in the loss of revenue if that	See answers from 08.31.26 1.) Regardless of building size or split schedules, every student receives 2 days of Arts Programming (typically 1 day of Art and 1 day of Music), 2 days of PE, and 1 day of Library weekly. We have also put together this Overview for K-5 Staffing Models that detail the requirements and allocations of FTE for K-5. 2) Yes. Space for specials and the ability to schedule all students for required programming are part of the school-level operational feasibility review. Specials may occur in classrooms, gymnasiums or other specialized spaces. Many schools within PPS who have greater than 350 students are already successfully scheduling specials for all of their students. The Academics teams will continue to provide scheduling guidance and support to building administrators. 3.+) Utilization compares student enrollment to the building's calculated instructional capacity. The utilization model is a system-level planning measure and may not reflect how individual rooms are currently being used or current class sizes. Specialized and early-learning programs are factored into the utilization rate for each school where such programming occurs. For rightsizing planning, specialized programs are being reviewed separately from general enrollment utilization, including their space requirements, student transition needs, and potential operational or financial impacts. Any scenario affecting specialized programs would need to identify where and how they would be accommodated.

		school is closed? Or where those students will go? Are those students being factored into the utilization rate for Creston (or any school that has a P4A or PK program?)?	
9/8/26	Rightsizing	I'm reading through the presentation for tonight and would love for the District to share how many buildings we have in our inventory that have a functional capacity that can support 360 students in grades K-5. Also, I don't see a number in the presentation for the goal enrollment for middle schools. What is that number and how many buildings do we have with a functional capacity that can support that number?	There are no current K-5 buildings with a functional capacity below 360. For K-8s or other configurations - currently, East Sylvan, Skyline, Winterhaven, and Terwilliger sites have functional capacities below 360. Sunnyside is just below 500 around 490. There are no middle schools with a functional capacity under 500. The smallest is Gray with 588 then George at 623.
	Rightsizing	Dr. Armstrong was very excited at the start of the 25-26 school year to say how we saw a first-in-a-while uptick in kindergarten enrollment. For the start of this 26-27 school year, for the schools I have been at or talked to families at, it seems we will see *another* uptick. (a) is this accurate? Will we see an enrollment increase? (b) is that being factored into this process?	a) While individual school communities may feel visually full or see small localized entry spikes, our district-wide metrics, tracked against the locked baseline projections established last spring and summer, show a different overall picture: Kindergarten Enrollment: As of today (9/11/2026), Kindergarten enrollment is running 115 students below the baseline projections established last spring/summer, and sits 65 students below last year's counts. Total K–12 Enrollment: Total enrollment is tracking below target with our locked spring/summer baseline (about 200 students below), and is about 700 students below last year's official October counts. (b) These locked spring and summer baseline projections form the foundation of our financial and operational modeling as we evaluate the necessary magnitude of rightsizing. When we look at rightsizing, the goal is not to react to single-year spikes, but to address multi-year structural declines.

	Rightsizing	Class size. My kids have been at the larger schools (500+ in kindergarten and 500+ now in middle school) and the class sizes have not been reasonable, they have been huge. And as a result, families have left the district for choice elsewhere. I have anecdotal information I won't type out here, but nowhere in "well resourced schools" did I hear mention of recognizing that class size is critical. Is class size capping part of the conversation at all?	Class size capping is not a part of the rightsizing conversation.
9/10/26	Rightsizing	This is a K-8 slide. I don't see comparable slides for K-5 & Middle Schools. Will they be added?	No, this slide accounts for the percentage of focal students in kindergarten through eighth grade across the district. It is not students in K8 schools only.
9/10/26	Rightsizing	Please provide actual number of school sites, not just percentages.	K-5 T1 4 out of 22 and then 2 out of 22 K-5 Non T1 8 out of 23 and then 6 out of 23 K-8 T1 1 out of 2 and then 1 out of 2 K-8 Non T1 2 out of 11 and then 1 out of 11 MS T1 2 out of 7 and then 0 out of 7 MS Non T1 4 out of 8 and then 2 out of 8
9/10/26	Rightsizing	Please provide the underlying data with a list of school sites and the current + projected attendance that make up the total for each school.	Here is historical, current, and projected enrollment by school.
9/10/26	Rightsizing	Please include the number of focal students, not just the percentage, and clearly define who focal students are on this slide. We can't see the scope of the impact without the numbers.	These indicators will be for the scenarios and we will include the number as well as the percentage. Focal students include students experiencing poverty, historically underserved by race, students receiving special education services, and multilingual learners.

9/15/26	Rightsizing	I have questions that I wasn't able to ask but thought I'd send through since they're pertinent to the larger conversation: (1) Dr. Armstrong was very excited at the start of the 25-26 school year to say how we saw a first-in-a-while uptick in kindergarten enrollment. For the start of this 26-27 school year, for the schools I have been at or talked to families at, it seems we will see *another* uptick. (a) is this accurate? Will we see an enrollment increase? (b) is that being factored into this process? (2) Class size. My kids have been at the larger schools (500+ in kindergarten and 500+ now in middle school) and the class sizes have not been reasonable, they have been huge. And as a result, families have left the district for choice elsewhere. I have anecdotal information I won't type out here, but nowhere in "well resourced schools" did I hear mention of recognizing that class size is critical. Is class size capping part of the conversation at all? (3) Thank you for explaining how a full time art teacher can weave work into the core classes. I have heard a lot of question about "there simply isn't enough time in a day to give kids art 3-5	Question is broken out above

		times a week. What core class will go if we do that?" So understanding that a well resourced program doesn't necessarily mean more art class minutes but instead means more art throughout the day was helpful to me.	
9/21/26	Rightsizing	Can staff please provide a spreadsheet or document for every K-5, K-8, and middle school that shows: How many sections there are in each grade band and how many students are in each section. Please call out blended classrooms. I have not sense of how widespread this has become. For each of these schools, please list the following FTE (and any others that may be useful): Librarian, Visual Arts, Music, Band, School Counselor, SPED supports	This is a large spreadsheet that shows the following - Current enrollment for K-5 by school, program and grade level. -125 out of 717 originally allocated K-5 FTE was to blended classrooms. - It is possible that schools allocated equity or other FTE to unblend classes or in some cases blend classrooms depending on how enrollment occurred. - Current student count in classes at the 6-8 level - Staffing allocations made last Spring to schools -Includes Librarian, VIsual Arts, Music and School Counselor on the School Detail for ISR tab -Includes SPED Supports on the SPED tab